

Email OS - Project Brief for Claude Code

Project: Email OS

Build a lightweight self-hosted email marketing system to replace GetResponse. **Goals**

- Manage contacts
- Send newsletters
- Run email sequences
- Handle unsubscribes
- Track basic events
- Use Amazon SES for delivery
- Self-host on a VPS
- Keep costs extremely low

Infrastructure

- VPS
- Amazon SES
- SPF, DKIM, DMARC
- PostgreSQL database

MVP Features

1. Contact Management

- Email, Name, Tags, Source, Created Date, Status
- Status: active, unsubscribed, bounced, complained

2. Newsletter Campaigns

- Create, save draft, schedule, send
- Subject, HTML, text version, statistics

3. Email Sequences

- Day 0 Welcome
- Day 2 Email #2
- Day 5 Email #3
- Day 10 Email #4

4. Unsubscribe System

- One-click unsubscribe
- List-Unsubscribe headers
- Prevent future sends

5. Bounce & Complaint Handling

- Process SES webhooks
- Automatically suppress contacts

6. Click Tracking

- Record clicks
- Redirect to destination URL

7. Open Tracking (optional)

- Tracking pixel

Database Entities

Contacts, Tags, ContactTags, Campaigns, Sequences, SequenceSteps, Events.

UI Pages

Dashboard, Contacts, Campaigns, Sequences, Templates, Settings.

Architecture Priorities

1. Reliability
2. Simplicity
3. Deliverability
4. Low Cost
5. Easy Maintenance

Important

Do not build Mailchimp. Build a simple creator-focused Email OS.